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Enron Corp.
Case No. EC-2002-01038
Doc No. EE8A33DFC
Date: 01/15/2003
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From: Internet Stock News <newsletters@123jump.com>
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To: alewis@enron.com
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INTERNET STOCK NEWS [tm]
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ISN Ones to Watch 11/27/2001: Too Soon To Tell

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1. Overall Sentiment

The first official day of what is known among retailers as the "Christmas Sell-Through Season" began early Friday morning, Nov. 23.

In the market research I currently do for Ticker Magazine, a 123Jump.com property, I phoned into S.G. Cowen in Manhattan that day, and the receptionist told me the financial district was a "ghost town."

One of the few days, she said, when the subway ride from Brooklyn into the financial district was "heavenly." There wasn't even a crowd outside the local Macy's department store.

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We should all hope that a crowd did gather outside Macy's, as well as the rest of the retail outlets, not only in Manhattan, but also across the U.S., that opened at 6:00 a.m. Eastern time that day to receive the throngs of shoppers wanting to get a head start.

The drive to those retail outlets should be much cheaper compared to how it was just two months ago.

On my weekly Saturday taxi ride to the supermarket, the local convenience store posted its price for a gallon of regular - $0.99.99 - down from $1.02.99 from the previous Saturday.

My driver had predicted a drop to under $1.00 by Christmas. On the drive last Saturday, he also mentioned that the traffic was unusually heavy.

Based on this rudimentary observation of the onset of the Christmas Sell-Through Season, we're off to a good start.

Still, it is too soon to tell.

For folks curious about how retailers are doing during this period, a good source is www.telecheck.com, a division of Equifax (EFX) that monitors check processing.

Meanwhile, it has been eight solid weeks of advances for the popular indexes since the last 52-week bottom Sept. 21.

It should be pointed out that after the prior 52-week bottom April 3-4, the marker rallied for about eight weeks into early June, stalled, shuffled sideways for most of that month and during July, and then began another slide during August and early September.

All during that time, the TV stock market channels, dead-tree media and online media continued to trot out the usual gang of "chief market strategists" who talked about a "V-shaped" recovery in 2002.

Put it into technology, they said. They said this in January, February, March, April, May, June, July, August, September, October and, of course, the final week of

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November.

Do you folks think this spiel will change next month, or the month after that?

Sooner or later (hope it's not later), they will be right.

Overall, the charts of the world's stock exchanges mostly reflect the charts for the S&P 500 and the Nasdaq indexes: a 52-week bottom on or around Sept. 21, followed by an advance to near the 200-day simple moving average (SMA).

There are a few exceptions, the most notable being the Russian stock market. This market has been among the top performers in 2001, as the following link to a one-year chart, courtesy of Yahoo! Finance, will display:

SEE:

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